

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #002 — Live-Action Studio Name
An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

1. The Decision

LIVE-ACTION STUDIO: **Motown Productions**

Motown's own real film and TV company, brought back to make every live-action TMU film

2. Why Motown Productions

Marvel Studios was Marvel's own in-house film company. Motown already had one, so we don't need to invent a name. We bring the real one back.

- **It really existed.** Motown Productions was Berry Gordy's film and television company. A 100% faithful franchise uses the real name.
- **It has a strong track record.** Motown Productions was not a vanity label. This is what it actually made:

Year	Title	Documented result
1972	<i>Lady Sings the Blues</i>	Five Academy Award nominations, including Best Actress for Diana Ross
1975	<i>Mahogany</i>	Directed by Berry Gordy. “Theme from Mahogany (Do You Know Where You're Going To)” was nominated for Best Original Song
1978	<i>The Wiz</i>	Co-produced with Universal. Starred Diana Ross and Michael Jackson
1983	<i>Motown 25: Yesterday, Today, Forever</i>	Emmy-winning TV special. Michael Jackson did the moonwalk on television for the first time
1985	<i>The Last Dragon</i>	Released as “Berry Gordy's The Last Dragon”. Became a cult classic
1989	<i>Lonesome Dove</i>	Emmy-winning CBS miniseries

- **It has a real leader to honor.** Suzanne de Passe ran Motown Productions. She shared an Oscar nomination for writing *Lady Sings the Blues* and produced *Motown 25* and *Lonesome*

Dove. Bringing the company back honors her work too.

- **It's the only name that doesn't shortchange the history.** An invented studio name would erase a real legacy. Under the No-Nerf Mandate, that legacy stays at full strength.

3. Names Considered

Candidate	Verdict
Motown Productions	SELECTED. It's the real company, it has Oscar and Emmy credits, and it was Motown's own. It does the same job Marvel Studios did for Marvel.
Motown Studios	Rejected. The name is made up, and it's easy to confuse with Hitsville's real recording room, Studio A ("the Snakepit").
Hitsville Pictures	Rejected. The name is made up and has no real history behind it.
Gordy Films	Rejected. It credits one man and leaves out de Passe and the rest of the team.

4. Branding

- **Credit line:** *MOTOWN PRODUCTIONS presents.* Changed by Memo #007: no "Motown Universe" branding appears on screen or in marketing until the reveal.
- **Tagline:** *The Sound of Young America.* This was Motown's real slogan and was chosen in Memo #001.
- **Scope:** Motown Productions makes the live-action films. We'll decide later which company handles TV, animation or anything else.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal Music Group or Marvel Studios.